

WHO CONTROLS BITCOIN?

A Deep Research Report on the World's Top 20 Biggest Bitcoin Holders

FILE 1 OF 3 · THE ORIGINS

Category 1: The Legend · Category 2: The Exchanges

This file covers the very foundations of Bitcoin ownership — the anonymous genius who created it and still holds over 1 million coins, and the four major exchanges that custody billions of dollars of Bitcoin on behalf of millions of users worldwide.

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NBZ Research Division · May 2026

Data sourced from: Arkham Intelligence · BitcoinTreasuries.net · SEC EDGAR · Cointelegraph · Wikipedia · Forbes · Britannica · 99Bitcoins · Webopedia

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Each entity profile covers: full background history · 8 key people with complete biographies · Bitcoin acquisition & trade history · current holdings & USD value · market impact analysis.

CATEGORY 1

THE LEGEND

The most consequential unknown in all of financial history. A person — or group — who invented a \$1.6 trillion asset, built it from nothing, gave it to the world, and then vanished without a trace.

01 · Satoshi Nakamoto

ENTITY #01 · INDIVIDUAL · THE LEGEND · CATEGORY 1

Satoshi Nakamoto

HOLDINGS	% OF SUPPLY	LAST ACTIVE	COINS MOVED
1,096,000 BTC	5.50%	April 2011	Zero
Est. ~\$89 Billion	Of all Bitcoin ever	Final email sent	Since mid-2010

WHO IS SATOSHI NAKAMOTO?

Satoshi Nakamoto is the pseudonym — and quite possibly the most consequential alias in the history of human finance — of the person or group who invented Bitcoin. The name is Japanese in origin: Satoshi translates roughly to 'clear-thinking' or 'quick-witted,' Naka means 'inside' or 'relationship,' and Moto means 'origin' or 'foundation.' Whether the choice of this name carries deliberate meaning, or whether it is simply a veil of misdirection, nobody knows.

What is known is that on Halloween — October 31, 2008 — Satoshi published the Bitcoin whitepaper on the Cryptography Mailing List: nine pages of mathematical poetry titled 'Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System.' The timing was not coincidental. The world was in the depths of the 2008 financial crisis. Banks were being bailed out. Lehman Brothers had collapsed five weeks earlier. The existing financial system had failed spectacularly. Satoshi's whitepaper proposed something radical: a form of money that required no banks, no governments, no trusted intermediaries of any kind.

Satoshi did not appear from nowhere. They built upon decades of cryptographic work — David Chaum's eCash system from the 1980s, Wei Dai's b-money proposal from 1998, Nick Szabo's Bit Gold concept from 2005, and most critically, Adam Back's Hashcash proof-of-work system. Satoshi synthesised all of these into a single working solution that solved the double-spending problem — the fundamental challenge that had prevented digital money from working without a central authority.

THE BITCOIN ORIGIN TIMELINE

- Oct 31, 2008** Bitcoin whitepaper published on the Cryptography Mailing List under the pseudonym Satoshi Nakamoto.
- Jan 3, 2009** The Genesis Block (Block 0) is mined. Embedded inside: 'The Times 03/Jan/2009 Chancellor on brink of second bailout for banks.' A deliberate, defiant message.
- Jan 9, 2009** Bitcoin software version 0.1 released to the public. The Bitcoin network goes live.
- Jan 12, 2009** First-ever Bitcoin transaction: Satoshi sends 10 BTC to cryptographer Hal Finney, who runs the first Bitcoin node after Satoshi.
- Oct 5, 2009** First published Bitcoin exchange rate appears: \$1 USD = 1,309.03 BTC, calculated based on the electricity cost of mining.
- May 22, 2010** Bitcoin Pizza Day. Laszlo Hanyecz pays 10,000 BTC for two pizzas — the first commercial Bitcoin transaction. Those coins are now worth hundreds of millions.
- Jun 2010** Satoshi steps back from public-facing Bitcoin development. Hands code repository access to Gavin Andresen.
- Dec 2010** Final public forum post by Satoshi Nakamoto.
- Apr 23, 2011** Final known communication: a private email to developer Gavin Andresen simply states 'I've moved on to other things.' Satoshi vanishes completely.
- 2011 onwards** Not a single satoshi moves from Satoshi's wallets. Complete, permanent silence.

HOW SATOSHI ACQUIRED 1,096,000 BTC

Satoshi did not buy Bitcoin. They mined it. In the very earliest days of the network — from January 2009 through mid-2010 — the Bitcoin network had virtually no other participants. With almost no competition, Satoshi mined block after block, earning 50 BTC per block under the original block reward. This was not greed; it was necessity. Someone had to run the network until others joined.

The forensic identification of Satoshi's coins was achieved through a technique called the Satoshi Pattern, first developed by Bitcoin researcher Sergio Lerner. The pattern relates to an unusual value in the extra nonce field of the blocks Satoshi mined — a specific signature visible only in the earliest Bitcoin blocks. Using this pattern, blockchain analytics firm Arkham Intelligence has attributed approximately 22,000 blocks to Satoshi, yielding 1,096,000 BTC spread across roughly 21,900 separate wallet addresses. The coins are deliberately split across thousands of addresses — a deliberate privacy measure, or perhaps a sign of multiple contributors to the 'Satoshi' identity.

"Not a single satoshi from these wallets has moved since mid-2010. If Satoshi is alive, they are sitting on the single greatest untouched personal fortune in human history. If they are gone, those coins are lost forever — reducing Bitcoin's effective supply by 5.5%, making every other coin slightly more scarce."

HOW SATOSHI'S COINS WERE CREATED — FLOW DIAGRAM



From January 2009 to mid-2010, Satoshi mined approximately 22,000 blocks solo at 50 BTC each. The coins have never been spent. They sit distributed across ~21,900 wallet addresses.

THE IDENTITY MYSTERY — 8 KEY FIGURES & SUSPECTS

Despite 17 years of investigation by journalists, cryptographers, law enforcement agencies, and the entire global crypto community, Satoshi's true identity remains one of the great unsolved mysteries of the modern world. Here are the eight most significant figures in that story.

Satoshi Nakamoto

The Pseudonymous Creator (Identity: Unknown)

Active from 2008 to April 2011. Communicated via email and the BitcoinTalk forum. Wrote in flawless English with occasional British spellings — 'colour,' 'favour,' 'grey.' Demonstrated deep knowledge of economics, cryptography, peer-to-peer networking, and C++ programming. Never revealed any personal information — no photo, no real name, no voice recording has ever been confirmed. The switching between British and American English in Satoshi's writings has led some researchers to believe 'Satoshi' was actually a group of people working collaboratively under a single identity.

Hal Finney

Cryptographer — Received First Bitcoin Transaction (1956–2014)

Hal Finney was a legendary cryptographer who developed the PGP email encryption standard and was deeply embedded in the cypherpunk community. He was the first person outside Satoshi to run a Bitcoin node and the recipient of the first-ever Bitcoin transaction — 10 BTC sent directly from Satoshi on January 12, 2009. He lived in Temple City, California, just blocks away from a man named Dorian Nakamoto (see below). Finney was diagnosed with ALS (Lou Gehrig's disease) in 2009 and spent his final years contributing to Bitcoin development from a wheelchair. He passed away on August 28, 2014, and was cryogenically preserved. He denied being Satoshi repeatedly and with evident sincerity. His proximity to Dorian Nakamoto, his deep involvement with early Bitcoin, and his extraordinary technical capability make him the most compelling internal candidate.

Nick Szabo

Computer Scientist, Creator of 'Bit Gold'

Nick Szabo is a computer scientist and legal scholar who proposed 'Bit Gold' in 2005 — a decentralised digital currency concept that is strikingly similar to Bitcoin in architecture and philosophy. Multiple linguistic analysis studies have found that Szabo's writing style closely matches Satoshi's whitepaper. He was among the first people Satoshi contacted when developing Bitcoin. Szabo has consistently denied being Satoshi, though observers have noted that his denials lack the passion of someone genuinely offended by the suggestion. He created the concept of 'smart contracts' and remains a highly influential figure in the crypto space.

Adam Back

British Cryptographer, Inventor of Hashcash — Named in 2026 NYT Investigation

Adam Back invented Hashcash in 1997 — the proof-of-work algorithm that Bitcoin's mining system is directly based on. He is cited in the Bitcoin whitepaper. A 2026 investigation by the New York Times named Back as the most likely candidate for Satoshi based on forensic stylometric analysis of writing patterns, technical fingerprints, and circumstantial evidence. Back is the CEO of Blockstream, the most significant Bitcoin infrastructure company in existence. He has denied being Satoshi publicly. His denial has been calm and measured — neither outraged nor particularly forceful.

Dorian Nakamoto

Japanese-American Engineer in California (Wrongly Identified)

In March 2014, Newsweek published a cover story claiming a 64-year-old Japanese-American engineer in Temple City, California — whose full legal name was Dorian Prentice Satoshi Nakamoto — was Bitcoin's creator. The story pointed to his technical background, his name, and a statement he allegedly made about 'no longer being involved.' Dorian Nakamoto vigorously denied the claim. A journalist chased him from his house to a sushi restaurant. The case quickly fell apart under scrutiny. He was definitively not Satoshi — but the media circus around him remains one of the most embarrassing episodes in crypto journalism.

Craig Wright

Australian Computer Scientist — Discredited Claimant

Craig Wright is the only person who has publicly and repeatedly claimed to be Satoshi Nakamoto, doing so since 2015. He is also, by near-universal consensus in the crypto community, not Satoshi Nakamoto. In March 2024, a UK High Court judge ruled definitively that Wright was not Satoshi, stating that he had 'lied to the court extensively and repeatedly' and had submitted forged evidence. Wright had sued multiple Bitcoin developers claiming ownership of the Bitcoin protocol. His cases collapsed. His claims have been rejected by every serious cryptographer who has examined his evidence.

Gavin Andresen

Lead Developer — The Man Satoshi Trusted Most

Gavin Andresen was the person Satoshi chose to hand Bitcoin to. When Satoshi stepped back, they gave Andresen control of the source code repository and designated him as lead developer. Andresen steered Bitcoin's early development from 2011 through around 2016 before being removed as lead maintainer. He was not Satoshi — their email correspondence is well-documented. But he knew Satoshi better than anyone, and has stated he believed Craig Wright was Satoshi — a position he has since walked back. Andresen's trust in Wright and his subsequent public embarrassment when Wright was exposed as a fraud remains one of the most complex personal stories in Bitcoin history.

Martti Malmi (Sirius)

Finnish Developer — Satoshi's First Real Collaborator

Martti Malmi, known online as 'Sirius,' was one of the very first people to contact Satoshi and help develop Bitcoin in 2009. He maintained the Bitcoin.org website, helped write documentation, and was one of the few people to exchange significant numbers of emails with Satoshi over an extended period. Those emails — released publicly by court order during the Craig Wright litigation — provide the most detailed picture we have of Satoshi's personality: thoughtful, careful, humble about Bitcoin's prospects, deeply concerned about privacy, and passionately opposed to the corruption of the traditional financial system.

BITCOIN ACQUISITION & HOLDING HISTORY

Satoshi's Bitcoin history is unique among every entity in this report: it involves no purchases, no sales, and no external transactions of significance. Everything came from mining in the network's infancy.

▲ **BUY** Jan 3, 2009 · 50 BTC · \$0.00/BTC · Total: \$0.00 (mined) — *Genesis Block — Block 0. Mining begins.*

▲ **BUY** Jan 9–12, 2009 · 50 BTC/block (ongoing) · \$0.00/BTC · Total: Mined — *Network launches. First Bitcoin sent to Hal Finney.*

▲ **BUY** Jan 2009 – Jun 2010 · ~1,096,000 BTC total · \$0.00/BTC · Total: Mined — *Solo mining across ~22,000 blocks. No competition.*

◆ **NOTE** Mid-2010 · Satoshi's last known mining activity. Coins distributed across ~21,900 addresses.

◆ **NOTE** Apr 23, 2011 · Final email to Gavin Andresen. Complete disappearance from all communication channels.

◆ **NOTE** 2011 – May 2026 · Zero movement from any identified Satoshi wallet. Not a single coin transferred in 15 years.

MARKET IMPACT & WHY IT MATTERS

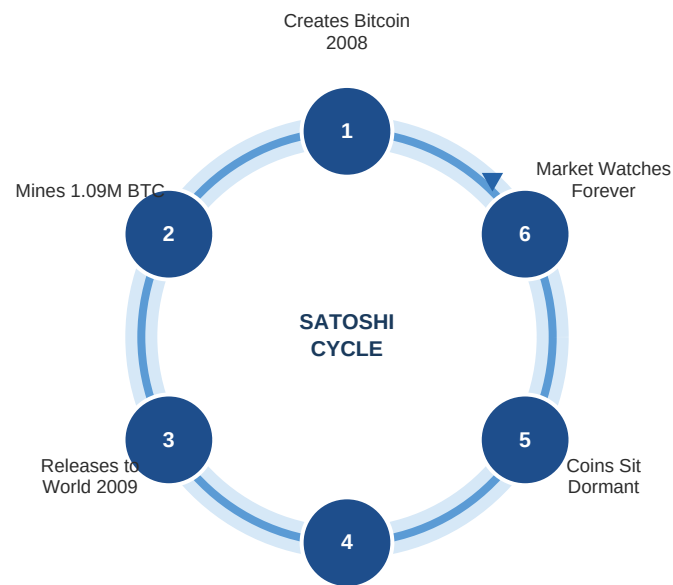
Satoshi Nakamoto's 1,096,000 BTC holdings are not just historically significant — they have active, ongoing effects on Bitcoin's market and culture today.

The permanent dormancy of these coins effectively removes them from Bitcoin's liquid supply. Since most analysts believe Satoshi cannot or will not ever move these coins, Bitcoin's real circulating supply is approximately 1.1 million coins smaller than the nominal figure. This makes every other holder's coins fractionally more scarce — a constant, passive upward pressure on value.

Every known Satoshi wallet address is monitored in real time by hundreds of blockchain analysts, automated alert systems, and obsessive community members around the world. If even a single satoshi moves from one of these addresses, it would immediately trigger global news coverage and a dramatic market reaction. The 'Satoshi wallet alert' is Bitcoin's equivalent of a nuclear launch code — a thing the entire world watches for and hopes never happens.

Satoshi's deliberate disappearance was also, paradoxically, essential to Bitcoin's success. By stepping away completely, they ensured the network has no founder to subpoena, no leader to arrest, no single point of human failure. Bitcoin has no CEO. No one can be pressured to change the rules. Satoshi's absence is, in a very real sense, Bitcoin's greatest security feature.

SATOSHI'S PLACE IN THE BITCOIN ECOSYSTEM — CYCLE DIAGRAM



The six stages of Satoshi's relationship with Bitcoin — from creation to eternal dormancy. The cycle has no end: the market will watch those wallets forever.

CATEGORY 2

THE EXCHANGES

These four exchanges are the custodians of the market. They do not own Bitcoin — they hold it on behalf of millions of users. But their market power, infrastructure, and influence over Bitcoin's price and liquidity is unmatched by any other category of holder.

02 · Coinbase 03 · Binance 04 · Robinhood 05 · Bitfinex

ENTITY #02 · EXCHANGE · CUSTODIAN · CATEGORY 2

Coinbase Global, Inc.

CUSTODY HOLDINGS	USD VALUE	FOUNDED	USERS
~958,000 BTC	~\$78 Billion	June 2012	100M+ Verified
Primarily client assets	At ~\$81,000/BTC	San Francisco, CA	Across 100+ countries

COMPANY BACKGROUND

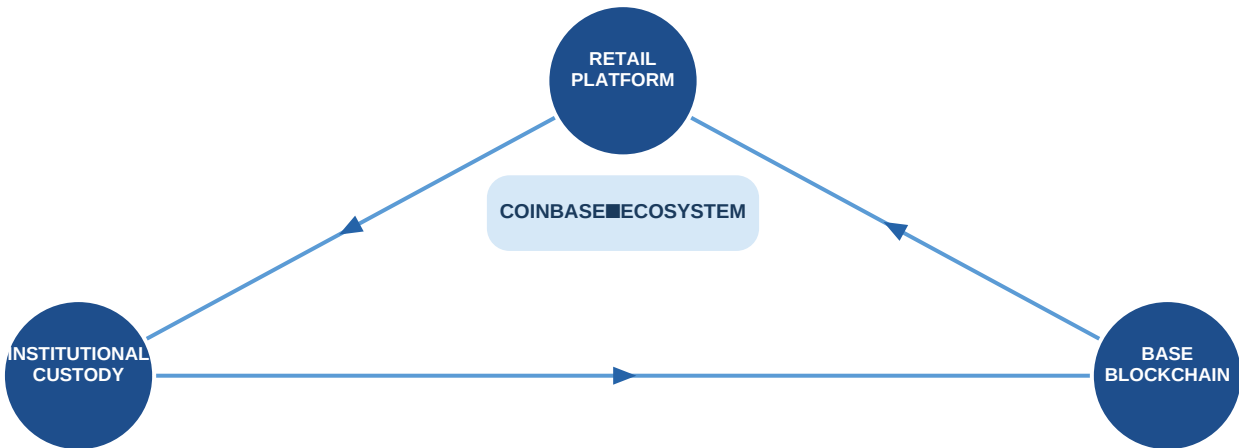
Coinbase is the largest cryptocurrency exchange in the United States and the most important institutional Bitcoin infrastructure company in the world. Founded in June 2012 in San Francisco, California, Coinbase was built on a deceptively simple idea: make buying Bitcoin as easy as buying something on Amazon. In 2012, that was a revolutionary concept. The only way to acquire Bitcoin at the time involved navigating complex peer-to-peer forums, sending wire transfers to strangers, and hoping your money arrived safely. Coinbase changed all of that.

On April 14, 2021, Coinbase became the first major cryptocurrency company to go public in the United States, listing directly on Nasdaq at an opening price that valued the company at over \$100 billion. It was one of the most significant moments in the history of institutional crypto adoption — the day Wall Street officially acknowledged that cryptocurrency exchanges were legitimate, mature businesses.

Coinbase's most strategically critical function today is its role as custodian for institutional Bitcoin. Coinbase Custody holds Bitcoin on behalf of BlackRock's iShares Bitcoin Trust (IBIT), several other spot Bitcoin ETF products, and hundreds of institutional clients. This makes Coinbase the single most systemically important company in Bitcoin's institutional infrastructure — the vault that holds the world's most valuable digital assets.

As of May 2026, Coinbase serves over 100 million verified users across more than 100 countries. The company generates revenue through transaction fees, interest income on customer deposits, and institutional custody and subscription services. Revenue reached \$7.4 billion in 2024 as Bitcoin's bull market drove a surge in trading activity.

THE COINBASE ECOSYSTEM — THREE PILLARS



Coinbase operates three interlocking businesses: retail trading for everyday investors, institutional custody for ETF issuers and asset managers, and Base — its own Ethereum Layer-2 blockchain.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Brian Armstrong

Co-Founder & Chairman / CEO

Brian Armstrong was born on January 25, 1983, near San Jose, California. Both of his parents were engineers, which instilled an early and deep interest in technology and problem-solving. He attended Bellarmine College Preparatory, a Catholic all-male private high school in San Jose known for its rigorous academic standards. Armstrong then attended Rice University in Houston, Texas, graduating in 2005 with dual bachelor's degrees in Economics and Computer Science — a combination that would prove perfectly suited to building a financial technology company. He returned to Rice for a Master of Science in Computer Science, completing it in 2006. While still a student at Rice, Armstrong's entrepreneurial instincts emerged: he co-founded UniversityTutor.com in 2003, an online platform connecting students, parents, and private tutors worldwide, which he ran until it was acquired in 2014. After graduating, Armstrong built his career systematically: developer at IBM, risk management consultant at Deloitte and Touche, and then software engineer at Airbnb, where he worked on international payments and anti-fraud systems. It was this role at Airbnb — grappling daily with the complexity of moving money across borders — that led him to read Satoshi Nakamoto's Bitcoin whitepaper in 2010. The clarity of the whitepaper hit him like a revelation. In 2012, he applied to Y Combinator with a pitch to build a simple, legal, and easy-to-use Bitcoin exchange. He received a \$150,000 investment and began building Coinbase with co-founder Fred Ehrsam. Armstrong is known for his intensely apolitical management style — in September 2020, he banned internal political discussions at Coinbase and offered severance to any employee who disagreed, publicly losing around 5% of his workforce. His personal Bitcoin holdings are undisclosed but substantial. He married Angela Meng in 2024.

Fred Ehrsam

Co-Founder (Board Member)

Fred Ehrsam graduated from Duke University and worked as a currency trader at Goldman Sachs, where he spent two years before encountering Bitcoin in 2011. He reached out to Brian Armstrong after reading Armstrong's Y Combinator application and became co-founder and co-CEO of Coinbase in 2012. Ehrsam left Coinbase in 2017 to co-found Paradigm, a crypto-focused venture capital firm that has become one of the most influential investors in the blockchain space with billions in assets under management. He remains a Coinbase board member and significant shareholder. His transition from Wall Street currency trading to crypto pioneering is a template that many institutional finance professionals have since followed.

Emilie Choi

President & Chief Operating Officer

Emilie Choi is one of Silicon Valley's most respected technology executives. She joined Coinbase in 2018 from LinkedIn, where she led corporate development and oversaw some of the most significant deals in LinkedIn's history. As President and COO of Coinbase, Choi oversees day-to-day operations, international expansion, business development, and Coinbase's institutional business. She was instrumental in orchestrating Coinbase's acquisition of Xapo's institutional custody business in 2019 — a deal that vaulted Coinbase to the top of the institutional crypto custody market almost overnight, adding over \$7 billion in assets under custody. Choi is widely seen as a potential successor to Armstrong as CEO.

Alesia Haas

Chief Financial Officer

Alesia Haas joined Coinbase in 2018 as CFO, bringing significant public company financial leadership experience from her previous role as CFO of Och-Ziff Capital Management (now Sculptor Capital Management), a multi-billion dollar hedge fund. Haas played the central role in preparing Coinbase for and executing its landmark April 2021 direct listing on Nasdaq — one of the most closely watched financial events in Silicon Valley history. She has managed Coinbase's finances through multiple extreme market cycles, from the 2021 peak to the 2022 crypto winter and back to the institutional bull market of 2024-2025. Her work includes managing Coinbase's own crypto holdings on its balance sheet, which include significant Bitcoin and Ethereum positions.

Paul Grewal

Chief Legal Officer

Paul Grewal previously served as a United States Magistrate Judge for the Northern District of California — a federal judicial appointment that gave him enormous credibility and institutional knowledge of US regulatory processes. He joined Coinbase as CLO in 2019 and became the company's most public-facing defender during Coinbase's prolonged and contentious battle with the SEC under Chairman Gary Gensler. Grewal has been a prolific public voice, writing extensively about the need for clear crypto regulation and criticising what he describes as the SEC's 'regulation by enforcement' approach. When the SEC sued Coinbase in 2023, Grewal led the legal defence. The suit was eventually dropped after Gary Gensler resigned and was replaced by the more crypto-friendly Paul Atkins in 2025.

Lawrence Barcwell

Chief Compliance Officer

Barcwell oversees Coinbase's global anti-money laundering, know-your-customer, and regulatory compliance programmes across more than 100 countries. This role is arguably the most complex compliance challenge in the financial industry — managing the regulatory requirements of every major jurisdiction simultaneously for a platform handling billions in daily transactions. Barcwell's work is also critical to Coinbase's custodial business: institutional clients including BlackRock require their custodian to maintain the highest possible compliance standards.

Marc Andreessen

Board Director (Andreessen Horowitz / a16z)

Marc Andreessen is one of Silicon Valley's most influential venture capitalists and the co-creator of Mosaic — the first widely used web browser — and co-founder of Netscape. He co-founded Andreessen Horowitz (a16z) in 2009, which became one of the most respected venture capital firms in the world. Andreessen Horowitz was an early and significant investor in Coinbase, and Andreessen has served on the board since those early days. His firm's crypto division, a16z crypto, has been among the most vocal advocates for sensible crypto regulation in Washington DC, spending millions on lobbying and policy education efforts. Andreessen's endorsement of Coinbase in its early days gave the company institutional credibility at a time when most of Silicon Valley viewed Bitcoin with deep scepticism.

Gokul Rajaram

Board Director (Product & Strategy Expertise)

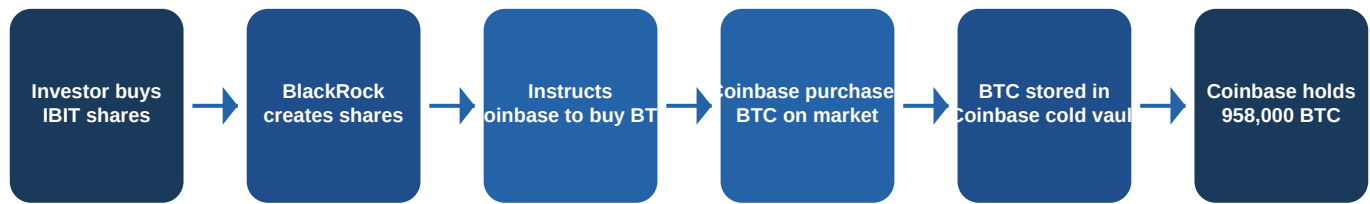
Gokul Rajaram is a veteran product executive who has held key roles at Google (Product Director for AdSense), Meta/Facebook (Director of Ads Products), and Square/Block where he led the Caviar food delivery service. He has served on Coinbase's board since August 2020, bringing deep expertise in consumer product development, digital advertising monetisation, and the payments ecosystem. His perspective at the board level helps Coinbase navigate the intersection of consumer technology and financial services.

BITCOIN CUSTODY — HOW COINBASE HOLDS 958,000 BTC

It is critical to understand what Coinbase's 958,000 BTC figure actually represents. This is not Coinbase's own Bitcoin — the vast majority of it belongs to Coinbase's customers and institutional clients. When you deposit Bitcoin on Coinbase, the company holds it in secure cold storage on your behalf. Coinbase itself acts as custodian, not owner.

The figure swelled dramatically following Coinbase's selection as the authorised participant and custodian for BlackRock's iShares Bitcoin Trust (IBIT) in 2024, as well as custodian for several other spot Bitcoin ETF products. Every share of IBIT that gets created requires BlackRock to purchase real Bitcoin and deposit it with Coinbase. As hundreds of thousands of investors bought IBIT, billions of dollars of Bitcoin flowed into Coinbase's cold storage vaults.

HOW COINBASE ETF CUSTODY WORKS — FLOW DIAGRAM



Every dollar invested in BlackRock's IBIT flows through this chain, ending with real Bitcoin held in Coinbase's custody vaults. This mechanism makes Coinbase the most systemically critical company in institutional Bitcoin infrastructure.

BITCOIN TRADE HISTORY — COINBASE AS CUSTODIAN

◆ **NOTE** June 2012 · Coinbase launches. Begins accumulating customer Bitcoin deposits from day one.

▲ **BUY** 2013–2017 · Millions of BTC · \$Varied/BTC · Total: Ongoing — *Rapid retail user growth drives custody holdings higher.*

▲ **BUY** 2019 · Xapo custody acquired · \$N/A/BTC · Total: \$55M deal — *Acquisition adds \$7B+ in institutional BTC to custody immediately.*

▲ **BUY** Jan 2024 · Massive inflows · \$\$40,000–\$70,000/BTC · Total: Billions — *Named custodian for IBIT, FBTC and other ETFs. Holdings surge.*

▲ **BUY** Oct 2025 · Holdings peak · \$\$95,000+/BTC · Total: Est. \$90B+ in custody — *IBIT alone crosses \$100B AUM.*

◆ **NOTE** May 2026 · ~958,000 BTC in custody. Remains #1 institutional Bitcoin custodian globally.

MARKET IMPACT

Coinbase occupies a position of extraordinary and unique importance in Bitcoin's market structure. As the largest US-regulated exchange, the primary custodian for institutional Bitcoin ETFs, and the gateway through which most American investors access Bitcoin, Coinbase is Bitcoin's single most critical institutional dependency. Its health, security, and regulatory standing directly affect Bitcoin's market stability in a way that no other private company does.

A catastrophic event at Coinbase — whether a security breach, a regulatory shutdown, or a solvency crisis — would represent the most severe disruption to Bitcoin's institutional market since the Mt. Gox collapse in 2014. The concentration of nearly 5% of Bitcoin's entire supply in a single company's custody systems represents Bitcoin's most significant single point of institutional concentration risk.

ENTITY #03 · EXCHANGE · CUSTODIAN · CATEGORY 2

Binance

CUSTODY HOLDINGS	USD VALUE	FOUNDED	DAILY VOLUME
~634,000 BTC	~\$51 Billion	July 2017	\$20B+
Customer assets	At ~\$81,000/BTC	Shanghai, China	World's largest exchange

COMPANY BACKGROUND

Binance is the world's largest cryptocurrency exchange by trading volume. It processes more Bitcoin trades in a single day than most stock exchanges process in a week. Founded in July 2017 by Changpeng Zhao in Shanghai, China, Binance grew from zero to the world's dominant crypto exchange in under 180 days — a pace of growth with no precedent in financial industry history.

Binance raised \$15 million in its July 2017 Initial Coin Offering and within months was processing billions in daily volume. The company became known for listing new cryptocurrency tokens faster than any competitor, aggressive global expansion, and its own Binance Smart Chain blockchain. Unlike Coinbase's compliance-first approach, Binance spent years operating in regulatory grey areas — a strategy that allowed explosive growth but eventually led to enormous legal consequences.

Binance's largest single Bitcoin cold wallet, at address 34xp4vRoCGJym3xR7yCVPFHoCNxv4Twseo, holds approximately 249,000 BTC — the single largest individual Bitcoin address on the entire blockchain. The total across all Binance wallets reaches approximately 634,000 BTC.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Changpeng Zhao — 'CZ'

Founder & Former CEO (Resigned November 2023, Incarcerated 2024)

Changpeng Zhao was born on September 10, 1977, in Jiangsu Province, China. When CZ was a teenager, political pressures in China led his family to emigrate to Canada, where they settled in Vancouver. CZ studied Computer Science at McGill University in Montreal — one of Canada's most prestigious universities — graduating with a strong technical foundation. After university, he joined the Tokyo Stock Exchange as a developer building matching engine systems — the core software that processes trades at high speed. He then moved to Bloomberg LP in New York, building financial data systems. These experiences gave him rare dual expertise in both high-speed trading technology and global financial infrastructure. In 2005, he returned to Shanghai to co-found Fusion Systems, building high-frequency trading systems for brokers. The story of CZ's Bitcoin conversion is one of crypto's most famous. In 2013, at a poker game in Shanghai, a fellow player suggested he sell his apartment and buy Bitcoin. Bitcoin was trading at around \$600. CZ sold his apartment. He was right. That conviction propelled him to work at OKCoin and Blockchain.com before founding Binance in 2017. In November 2023, Binance entered a \$4.3 billion settlement with the US Department of Justice, and CZ pleaded guilty to one count of failing to maintain an effective anti-money-laundering programme. He resigned as CEO and was sentenced to four months in federal prison, which he served and was released from in late 2024. Despite his legal troubles, CZ remains one of the wealthiest people in crypto with an estimated net worth of \$50+ billion.

Richard Teng

CEO (Since November 2023)

Richard Teng was appointed CEO of Binance the same day CZ stepped down. Teng is a Singapore-based former financial regulator with an immaculate compliance pedigree — precisely the kind of leader Binance needed in the aftermath of its \$4.3 billion DOJ settlement. Before joining Binance, Teng served as CEO of the Abu Dhabi Global Market Financial Services Regulatory Authority — one of the UAE's premier financial regulators. Before that he was CFO at Singapore Exchange (SGX). He had been Binance's Chief Regulatory Officer before his promotion, meaning he was deeply familiar with the company's compliance challenges. His appointment was a clear and credible signal that Binance intended to rebuild its regulatory relationships from the ground up.

Yi He

Co-Founder & Chief Marketing Officer

Yi He is Binance's co-founder and CMO, and arguably the most underrated figure in Binance's success story. Born in Sichuan Province, China, she was a television presenter and media personality before pivoting to cryptocurrency. She was one of the earliest employees at OKCoin exchange, where she met CZ. She co-founded Binance with CZ in 2017 and oversaw the company's branding, marketing, and community strategy during its explosive early growth. She and CZ were romantically involved for years and have children together. Yi He's role in building Binance's global brand and its community of traders — particularly in Asia — was foundational to the exchange's early dominance.

Rohit Wad

Chief Technology Officer

Rohit Wad leads all engineering and technology operations across Binance's massive global infrastructure, which must process millions of transactions per day across hundreds of trading pairs with near-zero downtime. His systems team oversees the security architecture protecting the 634,000 BTC across Binance's cold and hot wallets — one of the most critical security responsibilities in the financial world. Wad oversees Binance's ongoing work on BNB Chain infrastructure and the technical integration of Binance's exchange with multiple blockchain networks.

Noah Perlman

Chief Compliance Officer

Noah Perlman was recruited from Morgan Stanley in 2022 — a hire that sent a clear message about Binance's compliance intentions even before the DOJ settlement. Perlman previously served as a federal prosecutor in the Southern District of New York, heading the Organised Crime and Gangs unit. His appointment was widely interpreted as Binance hiring someone who understood exactly how federal prosecutors think — invaluable for a company navigating existential regulatory risk. Post-DOJ settlement, Perlman's work has focused on implementing the comprehensive compliance programme required under Binance's court-supervised probation.

Simon Ree

General Counsel

Oversees Binance's global legal strategy across more than 100 jurisdictions — an extraordinary complex mandate given that cryptocurrency regulation is evolving differently in virtually every country simultaneously. Ree coordinates with local legal teams in each market to ensure Binance maintains the licences and approvals needed to operate, while managing the ongoing legal aftermath of the 2023 DOJ settlement.

Tigran Gambaryan

Head of Financial Crime Compliance

Tigran Gambaryan is a former IRS Criminal Investigation Special Agent who became one of the most celebrated crypto law enforcement figures in history — and then one of its most prominent victims. As an IRS-CI agent, Gambaryan helped crack the Silk Road investigations and was instrumental in multiple major crypto seizure cases. He joined Binance to help build its compliance programme. In early 2024, he travelled to Nigeria for regulatory meetings and was detained by Nigerian authorities in a high-profile diplomatic incident, held for months in difficult conditions. He was eventually released after intense US diplomatic pressure and became a symbol of the geopolitical risks faced by crypto industry representatives operating in jurisdictions with unstable rule of law.

Patrick Hillmann

Former Chief Strategy Officer

Patrick Hillmann served as Binance's global communications chief and later Chief Strategy Officer during the most intense period of regulatory scrutiny the company faced. He became Binance's most visible spokesperson, appearing in countless media interviews defending Binance's compliance record. He departed Binance following the DOJ settlement as the company restructured its leadership to emphasise its compliance-first future direction.

BITCOIN CUSTODY HISTORY

◆ **NOTE** Jul 2017 · Binance launches. Rapid user growth begins. BTC custody scales from zero.

▲ **BUY** 2018–2020 · Hundreds of thousands of BTC · \$Varied/BTC · Total: Customer deposits — *Becomes world's #1 exchange by volume. Custody holdings surge.*

◆ **NOTE** May 2019 · Binance suffers \$40M Bitcoin hack. 7,000 BTC stolen from hot wallets via phishing and malware. Fully covered from Binance's Secure Asset Fund for Users (SAFU).

▲ **BUY** 2021–2022 · Peak period · \$\$30,000–\$60,000/BTC · Total: Billions in customer deposits — *Bull market drives massive new user onboarding.*

◆ **NOTE** Nov 2023 · CZ resigns. \$4.3B DOJ settlement. Richard Teng becomes CEO.

◆ **NOTE** May 2026 · ~634,000 BTC in custody. Remains world's #1 exchange by volume despite regulatory setbacks.

MARKET IMPACT

Binance's 634,000 BTC under custody and its position as the world's highest-volume exchange gives it enormous influence over Bitcoin's global price discovery. When Binance has technical issues or faces regulatory crackdowns, Bitcoin's price reacts immediately and sharply. The DOJ settlement in 2023 demonstrated that even the world's largest exchange is not too big to face consequences — and the market absorbed those consequences with surprising resilience.

ENTITY #04 · EXCHANGE · CUSTODIAN · CATEGORY 2

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

CUSTODY HOLDINGS	USD VALUE	FOUNDED	STOCK
~140,000 BTC	~\$11.3 Billion	April 2013	Nasdaq: HOOD
Customer assets	At ~\$81,000/BTC	Menlo Park, CA	\$70.35 — Mar 2026

COMPANY BACKGROUND

Robinhood Markets is the fintech company that shook the financial services industry to its foundations by eliminating brokerage commissions entirely. Founded in April 2013 by Vladimir Tenev and Baiju Bhatt in Menlo Park, California, Robinhood launched in 2015 with a single, disruptive idea: anyone with a smartphone should be able to invest in stocks for free. That idea forced every major US brokerage — Fidelity, Schwab, TD Ameritrade — to eventually eliminate their own trading commissions in response. Robinhood launched cryptocurrency trading in 2018, becoming one of the first mainstream financial apps to offer Bitcoin buying to retail users.

The company became briefly infamous during the January 2021 GameStop short squeeze, when it restricted trading of GameStop and other 'meme stocks' due to clearinghouse capital requirements. The decision sparked congressional hearings, a documentary film called Dumb Money, and lasting public controversy. CEO Vlad Tenev was portrayed by actor Sebastian Stan in the film. Despite the controversy, Robinhood emerged stronger, pivoting aggressively into crypto. In 2025, Robinhood completed its acquisition of Bitstamp for \$200 million — bringing over 50 international regulatory licences and opening institutional crypto markets.

Robinhood's cold wallet holds approximately 140,000 BTC — the third-largest single Bitcoin address on the blockchain — representing the accumulated deposits of Robinhood's 27 million+ funded account users as of end-2025.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Vladimir Tenev
Co-Founder, Chairman, CEO & President

Vlad Tenev was born in Varna, Bulgaria. His parents both worked for the World Bank, and the family emigrated to the United States when Vlad was just five years old, settling in the Washington DC area. Growing up in a household shaped by international economic development work gave Tenev an early exposure to global finance and the ways traditional financial systems exclude ordinary people. He attended Thomas Jefferson High School for Science and Technology in Fairfax County, Virginia — one of the most academically demanding public high schools in America. Tenev went on to Stanford University, where he earned a Bachelor of Science in Mathematics in 2009. He briefly enrolled in a PhD Mathematics programme at UCLA before choosing to leave academia for entrepreneurship. At Stanford he met Baiju Bhatt, the partner who would change his career. Before Robinhood, Tenev and Bhatt co-founded two financial technology companies in New York: Celeris in 2010, a high-frequency trading software firm, and then Chronos Research, which sold low-latency trading software to banks and investment firms. These ventures gave them direct experience building the kind of financial infrastructure they would later democratise. The insight behind Robinhood came from observing that the same high-frequency trading firms they were building software for paid essentially zero for trade execution, while ordinary retail investors paid \$7 to \$10 per trade. They decided to fix this. Today Tenev holds a 5.2% equity stake and 24% voting control in Robinhood. As of January 2026, his net worth was estimated at \$5.9 billion. He has been recognised on Fortune's 100 Most Powerful People in Business (2025) and is also co-founder of Harmonic, an AI reasoning engine company.

Baiju Bhatt

Co-Founder & Board Member

Baiju Bhatt was born in the United States to Indian immigrant parents. He studied Physics and Mathematics at Stanford University, earning both a BS in Physics and an MS in Mathematics — a combination that made him a natural fit for quantitative finance work. He met Vlad Tenev at Stanford and the two became close friends and later business partners. Bhatt co-founded Robinhood with Tenev in 2013 and served as co-CEO alongside Tenev until November 2020. He then served as Chief Creative Officer until March 2024, overseeing Robinhood's product design and brand. He holds a 7.8% equity stake and 40% voting control — making him the single largest voting shareholder. His departure from the executive team in 2024 marked a natural transition as Tenev took full operational leadership.

Jason Warnick

Chief Financial Officer

Jason Warnick has served as CFO of Robinhood since 2018, bringing significant financial leadership experience from his background in corporate finance and investor relations. He managed Robinhood through its July 2021 IPO — one of the most anticipated fintech listings of that decade — and through the subsequent volatility as Robinhood's stock fell dramatically before recovering. Warnick oversees the financial strategy supporting Robinhood's expansion into crypto trading, including the Bitstamp acquisition financing.

Steve Quirk

Chief Brokerage Officer

Steve Quirk oversees Robinhood's core brokerage operations, including the crypto trading platform that handles Bitcoin deposits and withdrawals for its 27 million+ account holders. He brings decades of brokerage industry experience that has helped Robinhood navigate the complex regulatory requirements of simultaneously operating as a stock broker, options platform, and crypto exchange.

Lucas Moskowitz

General Counsel & Chief Compliance Officer

Moskowitz oversees all legal and compliance functions at Robinhood, managing the company's relationships with the SEC, FINRA, and state-level regulators across the US, as well as international regulators in the UK, EU, and other markets entered through the Bitstamp acquisition.

Johann Kerbrat

VP & General Manager, Crypto

Johann Kerbrat leads Robinhood's cryptocurrency business unit, which has become one of the fastest-growing parts of the company. Under his leadership, Robinhood expanded its crypto listings significantly, launched crypto staking services for Ethereum and Solana, and moved into perpetual futures trading in EU markets. He is a key architect of Robinhood's ambition to become a full-service crypto platform beyond its original role as a basic Bitcoin buyer.

Robert Summers

Chief Product Officer

Oversees Robinhood's product strategy and development across all platforms — mobile, web, and API. Under Summers, Robinhood has significantly expanded its product suite to include retirement accounts (Robinhood Gold), margin trading, banking services, and the crypto features that now generate a growing proportion of the company's revenue.

Christine Brown

Chief Operating Officer, Crypto

Christine Brown runs the operational side of Robinhood's crypto business, overseeing the systems, processes, and partnerships needed to handle millions of Bitcoin transactions, maintain cold wallet security for 140,000+ BTC, and integrate the newly acquired Bitstamp infrastructure into Robinhood's broader crypto operations.

BITCOIN CUSTODY HISTORY

◆ **NOTE** Apr 2013 · Robinhood founded. Stock trading focused initially.

▲ **BUY** Feb 2018 · Bitcoin trading launched · \$~\$10,000/BTC · Total: Customer deposits — *First crypto feature. Zero-commission trading drives rapid adoption.*

◆ **NOTE** Jan 2021 · GameStop controversy. Robinhood restricts stock trading. Congressional hearings follow. Crypto trading unaffected.

▲ **BUY** 2021–2022 · Significant BTC · \$\$30K–\$60K/BTC · Total: Customer deposits — *Bull market surge in retail Bitcoin buyers on platform.*

◆ **NOTE** Jul 2021 · Robinhood IPO on Nasdaq. HOOD stock opens at \$38/share.

▲ **BUY** 2025 · Bitstamp acquired · \$\$200M deal/BTC · Total: 50+ global licences added — *Robinhood becomes a global crypto exchange operator.*

◆ **NOTE** May 2026 · ~140,000 BTC in custody. 27M+ funded accounts. 3rd-largest single Bitcoin address globally.

MARKET IMPACT

Robinhood's significance is demographic rather than volumetric. While it holds less Bitcoin than Coinbase or Binance, Robinhood is the primary onboarding point for younger, first-time American Bitcoin buyers — the generation of investors who will shape Bitcoin's market for the next two decades. Its Bitstamp acquisition has transformed it from a domestic retail platform into a genuine global crypto exchange with institutional ambitions.

ENTITY #05 · EXCHANGE · CUSTODIAN · CATEGORY 2

Bitfinex (iFinex Inc.)

CUSTODY HOLDINGS	USD VALUE	FOUNDED	PARENT COMPANY
~130,000 BTC	~\$10.5 Billion	2012	iFinex Inc.
Customer assets	At ~\$81,000/BTC	Hong Kong / BVI	Also owns Tether

COMPANY BACKGROUND

Bitfinex is one of the longest-running and most storied cryptocurrency exchanges in the world — and also one of the most controversial. Founded in 2012 by Raphael Nicolle out of the ashes of Bitcoinica (a previous exchange that was hacked and shut down), Bitfinex quickly became the premier exchange for high-volume, sophisticated Bitcoin traders. Based in Hong Kong under its parent company iFinex Inc., Bitfinex was known for advanced trading features — margin trading, order book depth, and professional-grade tools — long before competitors offered them.

Bitfinex's history is inseparable from two defining events. The first: the August 2016 hack, in which 119,754 BTC were stolen — then worth approximately \$72 million. It was the largest crypto exchange hack in history at the time. The second: the February 2022 recovery of 94,643 of those stolen coins by US federal agents — the largest financial seizure in US government history. Bitfinex survived both events, which speaks to the extraordinary resilience and institutional trust it had built with its user base.

Bitfinex is also inextricably linked to Tether — the dominant stablecoin operator. Both companies are controlled by iFinex Inc. and share significant executive overlap, including Giancarlo Devasini and JL van der Velde. This connection has made Bitfinex the subject of intense regulatory scrutiny over claims that Tether funds were improperly used to cover Bitfinex losses.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Raphael Nicolle

Founder

Raphael Nicolle is the original founder of Bitfinex, establishing it in 2012 after the collapse of Bitcoinica — a previous exchange he was involved with that was hacked. Little public information exists about Nicolle's background prior to Bitfinex. He built the original exchange platform and brought in Giancarlo Devasini as a financial partner. While Nicolle's operational role diminished over time as the iFinex structure evolved, he remains one of the founding architects of what became one of the most influential exchanges in crypto history.

JL van der Velde

Chief Executive Officer

Jan Ludovicus van der Velde — known universally as JL — was born in the Netherlands but has spent the vast majority of his career in Asia. In 1985, he relocated to Taiwan, where he studied Chinese language and technology at National Taiwan Normal University. After graduating, he remained in Asia and built a career spanning over 30 years in the international technology and business sector. His deep experience in Asian markets proved enormously valuable as Bitfinex grew its user base across China, Hong Kong, Japan, and Southeast Asia — regions that historically drove the largest volumes of Bitcoin trading globally. Van der Velde became co-founder and CEO of Bitfinex in 2013 and served simultaneously as CEO of Tether for a significant period as both companies grew under the iFinex umbrella. Forbes estimated his net worth at \$3.9 billion in 2024, surging to approximately \$9.5 billion by 2025 as Tether's profits reached extraordinary levels. Van der Velde is famously private — present but invisible, as one profile described him.

Giancarlo Devasini

Chief Financial Officer & Largest Shareholder

Giancarlo Devasini is one of the most remarkable self-reinvention stories in financial history. Born in Turin, Italy in 1964, Devasini studied medicine at the University of Milan, graduating in 1990. He practised as a cosmetic surgeon and plastic surgeon for approximately two years before a complete career pivot. He left medicine to enter the information technology business, founding several companies specialising in the distribution of computer components across Europe. His entrepreneurial path was turbulent: in 1995 he was accused of software piracy by Microsoft (paying a fine of one million lire to resolve it), and several of his companies subsequently went bankrupt. In 2012, Devasini discovered Bitcoin, met Raphael Nicolle, and joined Bitfinex as CFO and co-owner. Since then, he has been the primary architect of both Bitfinex's financial relationships and the growth of Tether. Devasini holds an estimated 47% stake in Tether's parent company. As of April 2026, Forbes ranks him as the 23rd-richest person in the world, with a net worth of approximately \$89.3 billion — making him the richest person in Italy. He splits his time between London and the French Riviera.

Paolo Ardoino

Chief Technology Officer at Bitfinex / CEO of Tether

Paolo Ardoino joined Bitfinex in early 2015 and rose to become CTO of Bitfinex while simultaneously becoming CEO of Tether in 2023. An Italian software engineer with deep expertise in distributed systems and cryptography, Ardoino is by far the most publicly visible face of the Tether and Bitfinex operations. He engages constantly on social media, attends major crypto conferences, and has become one of the most vocal defenders of Tether's reserve claims. His simultaneous leadership of both Bitfinex's technology and Tether's overall direction illustrates how deeply integrated the two companies are at the operational level.

Claudia Lagorio

Chief Operating Officer

Claudia Lagorio serves as COO of Bitfinex, overseeing day-to-day exchange operations including customer support, banking relationships, and operational risk management. Her role encompasses the enormously complex challenge of maintaining banking relationships for a crypto exchange that has faced persistent difficulty accessing traditional banking infrastructure due to its controversial history.

Stuart Hoegner

Former General Counsel (Retired)

Stuart Hoegner served as General Counsel of Bitfinex and Tether for many years and was one of the most important legal architects of both companies. He graduated from Yale University with a BA in Physics in 1994 before pursuing law. His physics background made him particularly effective in understanding the technical aspects of the crypto assets he was defending legally. He was a central figure in managing Bitfinex's legal response to the New York Attorney General's investigation, the 2016 hack aftermath, and the ongoing regulatory scrutiny. He retired from the role in 2024 and reportedly holds a 13% stake in Tether's parent company.

Philip Potter

Former Chief Strategy Officer

Philip Potter graduated from Yale University in 1994 with a BA in Physics and then worked as a derivatives analyst at Morgan Stanley before building automated portfolio management technologies. He served as Bitfinex's Chief Strategy Officer, bridging Wall Street financial knowledge with the emerging crypto trading world. His background gave Bitfinex credibility among the professional trading community that was crucial to Bitfinex's early reputation as a platform for serious traders.

Christopher Harborne

Early Investor — The Mystery Stakeholder

Christopher Harborne is a British-Thai dual citizen who reportedly held approximately a 13% stake in Tether's parent company as of 2018. He is known to be involved in the aviation industry in Southeast Asia. He has almost completely disappeared from public records related to Tether and Bitfinex since that time. At Tether's current estimated \$500 billion valuation, a 13% stake would represent approximately \$65 billion — making him one of the wealthiest people on Earth if he still holds his position. The opacity around his current involvement is one of many unanswered questions in the Bitfinex/Tether ownership structure.

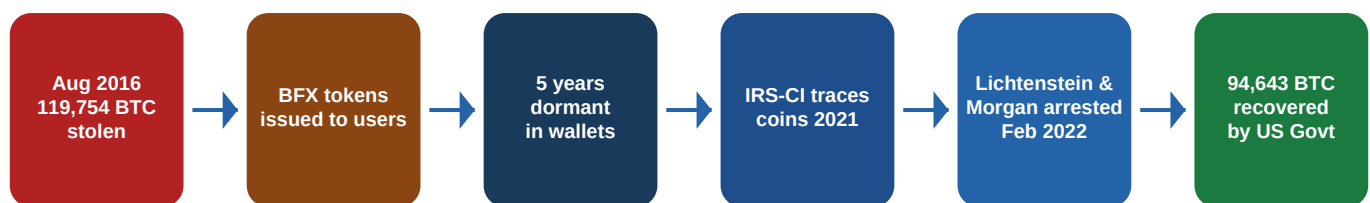
THE 2016 HACK — THE GREATEST BITCOIN THEFT STORY

On August 2, 2016, hackers breached Bitfinex's multi-signature wallet security system and stole 119,754 BTC — then worth approximately \$72 million. It was the largest cryptocurrency exchange hack in history at the time and one of the most audacious financial thefts ever attempted. The stolen coins sat in wallets untouched for over five years, occasionally shuffled through mixing services but never fully liquidated.

Bitfinex's response to the hack was unusual: rather than declaring bankruptcy (as Mt. Gox had done two years earlier), Bitfinex issued 'BFX tokens' to affected users representing their losses, and then systematically bought those tokens back at face value as the company recovered financially. All users were made whole within approximately eight months — a remarkable demonstration of operational resilience.

The denouement came on February 8, 2022, when US federal agents arrested a married couple in New York: Ilya Lichtenstein, a tech entrepreneur, and his wife Heather Morgan, a self-described rapper and entrepreneur who performed under the name Razzlekhan. IRS Criminal Investigation agents had spent years tracing the movement of the stolen coins through complex chain-hopping and mixing operations. They recovered 94,643 BTC from the couple's accounts — then worth \$3.6 billion, the largest financial seizure in US government history. Lichtenstein was sentenced to 5 years in prison, Morgan to 18 months.

THE BITFINEX HACK — FROM THEFT TO RECOVERY



BITCOIN CUSTODY & TRADE HISTORY

- ◆ **NOTE** 2012 · Bitfinex launches. Focused on professional traders. Rapid volume growth.
- ▲ **BUY** 2013–2015 · Significant BTC · \$Varied/BTC · Total: Customer deposits — *Becomes #1 exchange by USD/BTC volume globally.*
- ◆ **NOTE** Aug 2, 2016 · 119,754 BTC stolen in hack. BFX token system launched. Users eventually made whole.
- ◆ **NOTE** 2018 · NY Attorney General begins investigation into Tether/Bitfinex relationship. Lengthy legal battle follows.
- ◆ **NOTE** Feb 2022 · Lichtenstein and Morgan arrested. 94,643 BTC seized by US government. Bitfinex does not recover these coins.
- ◆ **NOTE** 2021 settlement · Bitfinex and Tether settle with NY Attorney General for \$18.5M. No admission of wrongdoing.
- ◆ **NOTE** May 2026 · ~130,000 BTC in customer custody. Still a major exchange for professional and institutional traders globally.

MARKET IMPACT

Bitfinex's 2016 hack and its aftermath fundamentally changed how the crypto industry thinks about exchange security. The incident was the catalyst for the widespread adoption of cold storage standards, multi-signature security requirements, and insurance programmes for exchange holdings. Bitfinex's survival and recovery also demonstrated that major exchanges could survive catastrophic security events if they had the institutional depth and user trust to manage the aftermath responsibly.

Bitfinex's connection to Tether — which issues more than \$140 billion of the world's most widely used stablecoin — makes its stability a matter of systemic significance for the entire crypto market. Any serious crisis at Bitfinex would immediately raise questions about Tether's backing, which could trigger contagion across the entire crypto ecosystem.